

PAPER PRESENTATION & REPORT ASSIGNMENT

ECO403/503–INTRODUCTION TO CONTRACT THEORY AND AUCTIONS

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Description This is an assignment for MA students. You will form in groups of two students and each group will chose a paper to present and write an extended abstract on. Each presentation will be 35 minutes long and the extended abstract should not exceed two pages.

When preparing the presentation and the extended abstract, keep in mind the following components:

1. Main question asked by the paper (Why is it important? How does it relate to the literature?)
2. The method used to answer the question
 - Theory: Brief description of the model.
 - Empirical: Brief description of the data and the statistical method.
3. Summary of the results.
4. Main limitations and possible lines of further research.

The extended abstract, as it name implies, is a longer version of the abstract commonly found at the beginning of any scientific paper. The extended abstract should summarize points 1–3. On the other hand, when you present the paper, you should discuss all points 1–4 with sufficient detail according to your allotted time (35 minutes).

The timetable for the assignment is as follows:

Date	Activity
October 20–November 7	Form your two-student groups and think about which paper you want to present. I will not allow for repeated papers, so please let me know as soon as possible when you are interested in presenting a particular paper.
November 8	Deadline for notifying me by email which paper your group selected.
November 15	Extended abstract submission deadline. I will share your abstracts with all the class so they have an idea what the paper is about before the presentations.
November 18 & 20	Paper presentations. We will have two 35 minutes presentations per class. When you notify me about your group, I will assign slots and dates randomly.

You may choose a theoretical or an empirical paper. Below I provide a list of papers to choose from, but you may, after consulting me, choose a paper that is not in the list. I recommend you to skim through the papers first and then choose one that you find interesting and manageable. The following papers are surveys and provide a general overview of the field as well as a discussion of many of the papers in the list:

1. Joseph E Stiglitz. “The contributions of the economics of information to twentieth century economics”. In: *The quarterly journal of economics* 115.4 (2000), pp. 1441–1478.
- 2.